



Student Portfolio: Arinda Tisha Irene

Student Information.

- **Full Name:** Arinda Tisha Irene
- **Student Number:** 25/1/370/D/1964
- **Role:** UI/UX Designer
- **Group Name:** BSE Year I Semester II Project Group 4
- **Course:** Software Engineering Principles II
- **Lecturer:** Mr. Luyiima Alex
- **Submission Date:** April 2026

Part A: Team Experience and Professional Conduct.

As the UI/UX Designer, I held primary responsibility for the visual identity and user experience of our Phase 4 prototype. This role involved defining the color palette, screen layouts, and navigation structures across three distinct user roles: the resident, the Admin, and the Waste Collector. Beyond the digital interface, I

contributed to the project's foundational research by conducting two key field interviews with a university alumna and the health officer in charge of the Ndejje community.

Design Successes and Limitations: I am particularly proud of the prototype's interface, specifically the choice of a deep green color system. This was a deliberate choice to communicate environmental health, cleanliness, and a sense of community, which I felt was essential for a village-based waste management system. A standout feature was my implementation of a color-coded fill-level progress bar that shifts from green to amber to red. This provides immediate visual feedback that a standard dropdown menu simply cannot offer. However, I recognize that I fell short regarding accessibility. I did not sufficiently account for users accessing the system via smaller mobile screens or older monitors, which is a significant limitation for a community-centered application.

Conflict Resolution and Team Dynamics: During Phase 4, a tense debate arose regarding the prototype's technology. While the Software Requirements Specification (SRS) defined a C# / Win Forms desktop application, I advocated for an HTML prototype to better showcase workflows. Some team members feared this compromised the project's integrity by deviating from our documentation. I argued that the Phase 4 brief allowed this flexibility and that a fully functional HTML prototype was superior to a partially functional Win Forms app. Ultimately, the Project Manager approved the HTML approach, resulting in a well-received final product, though the experience taught me the importance of maintaining consistency with formal documentation.

Ethical Considerations: In my interview with a university alumna, she shared candid, "off-the-record" skepticism regarding the local council's effectiveness. I faced an ethical dilemma: how to report this critical feedback honestly without exposing the individual. I chose to report the professional finding that "community members expressed low confidence in council accountability" in the SRS appendix without identifying her. Because this pattern was corroborated by other interviews, I felt it was more ethical to report the systemic issue rather than the specific person.

Part B: Gender-Responsive Design Reflection.

I conducted a pivotal interview (FV-003) with a male university alumna in the Ndejje area. Although he was an educated English speaker with high digital literacy, he observed a troubling social imbalance: the local council listened to him more readily than his neighbors, particularly women from the market, because of his formal education and language skills. He worried that a digital system might accidentally reinforce these existing social barriers.

Impact on Design and Self-Critique: This insight directly shaped my design of the waste report submission screen. I simplified the interface to its bare essentials fill level, location, and bin type to ensure residents with minimal digital literacy could use it independently. I also insisted on plain English for form validation, such as "Please describe the location," to avoid exclusionary technical jargon.

Despite these efforts, I must be honest about a major gap: the prototype is English-only. The SRS explicitly lists bilingual support (English and Luganda) as a "SHALL" requirement. As the designer, I failed to implement even a language toggle or placeholder translations for Luganda.

Professional Growth: Moving forward, I am adopting a new professional standard: before any design is finalized, I will evaluate whether it is accessible to those who are different from me those who speak different languages, use different hardware, or lack formal status. I have learned that empathy is not just a feeling; it is a professional discipline. Like the alumna I interviewed, I want to design systems that bridge the gap between diverse social worlds.